

BUILD YOUR AI CEO — THE COMPLETE SETUP GUIDE

Cron Job Command Cheat Sheet

Build Your AI CEO: The Complete Setup Guide — BONUS RESOURCE

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Copy-Paste Terminal Commands for OpenClaw Automation

Quick Reference: What Are Cron Jobs?

A **cron job** is a scheduled task that runs automatically at a set time — no manual trigger required. In OpenClaw, cron jobs let your AI execute specific prompts on a schedule: every morning, every night, every Monday, or any other time pattern you define.

Once a cron job is set, it runs silently in the background. You don't have to do anything — it just happens.

The Core Command: `openclaw cron add`

This is the command you use to create a new scheduled task.

Full Command Structure

▷ **TERMINAL COMMAND — COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL**

```
openclaw cron add \  
  --name "job-name" \  
  --schedule "CRON_EXPRESSION" \  
  --tz "Your/Timezone" \  
  --channel CHANNEL_ID \  
  --session-mode isolated \  
  --prompt "Your full prompt text here"
```

Flag-by-Flag Breakdown

Flag	What It Does
<code>--name</code>	A short, memorable name for this job. Use lowercase with hyphens. Example: <code>"morning-briefing"</code>
<code>--schedule</code>	The cron expression that defines when the job runs. See the Cron Schedule Syntax section below.
<code>--tz</code>	Your timezone. This ensures the job runs at the correct local time. Example: <code>"America/New_York"</code>
<code>--channel</code>	The Discord channel ID where the job will post its output. No quotes — just the numeric ID.
<code>--session-mode</code>	Use <code>isolated</code> for standalone background jobs. This keeps the job's session separate from your main conversation.
<code>--prompt</code>	The full text of what you want your AI to do when this job runs. This is your instruction.

Ready-to-Paste Commands

Nightly Memory Extraction — 11:00 PM Daily

Replace `YOUR_CHANNEL_ID` with your `#nightly-review` channel ID.

Replace `Your/Timezone` with your actual timezone.

▷ TERMINAL COMMAND — COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL

```
openclaw cron add \  
  --name "nightly-memory-extraction" \  
  --schedule "0 23 * * *" \  
  --tz "Your/Timezone" \  
  --channel YOUR_CHANNEL_ID \  
  --session-mode isolated \  
  --prompt "Review the full activity from today's sessions. Extract any durable facts to add to  
MEMORY.md — new preferences, decisions, venture updates, tool changes, or relationship context.  
Update MEMORY.md under the correct section headers without overwriting existing content. Update  
ACTIVE_TASK.json to reflect final task status. Then post a nightly summary to this channel with:  
Today's Summary (3–5 bullets), Memory Updates (what was added), Open Loops (tasks carrying to  
tomorrow), and System Status (confirmation complete). Keep it concise and scannable."
```

Morning Briefing — 8:00 AM Daily

Replace `YOUR_CHANNEL_ID` with your `#morning-brief` channel ID.

▷ TERMINAL COMMAND — COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL

```
openclaw cron add \  
  --name "morning-briefing" \  
  --schedule "0 8 * * *" \  
  --tz "Your/Timezone" \  
  --channel YOUR_CHANNEL_ID \  
  --session-mode isolated \  
  --prompt "Load SOUL.md, IDENTITY.md, MEMORY.md, USER.md, and ACTIVE_TASK.json. Generate a morning briefing and post it to this channel. Include: a good morning message with today's date, the top 3 priorities for the day in order of importance, status of any open or in-progress tasks, one specific high-leverage focus recommendation for today, any time-sensitive items with deadlines, and a brief confirmation that the system is loaded and ready. Be direct and actionable – no filler."
```

Weekly Performance Review — 6:00 PM Every Sunday

Replace `YOUR_CHANNEL_ID` with your `#strategy` channel ID.

▷ TERMINAL COMMAND — COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL

```
openclaw cron add \  
  --name "weekly-performance-review" \  
  --schedule "0 18 * * 0" \  
  --tz "Your/Timezone" \  
  --channel YOUR_CHANNEL_ID \  
  --session-mode isolated \  
  --prompt "Conduct a weekly performance review and post it to this channel. Include: Accomplishments (specific completed tasks and milestones), What Didn't Happen (and the root cause for each), Decisions Made this week and their rationale, one Key Insight about patterns or trends, one Top Recommendation for next week's highest-leverage focus, and a System Health confirmation that MEMORY.md and ACTIVE_TASK.json are current. Write as a direct executive summary."
```

Content Idea Generator — 9:00 AM Every Monday

Replace `YOUR_CHANNEL_ID` with your `#content` channel ID.

▷ TERMINAL COMMAND — COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL

```
openclaw cron add \  
  --name "content-idea-generator" \  
  --schedule "0 9 * * 1" \  
  --tz "Your/Timezone" \  
  --channel YOUR_CHANNEL_ID \  
  --session-mode isolated \  
  --prompt "Review MEMORY.md for current ventures and context. Generate 5 high-quality content ideas for the week. For each idea include: a specific compelling hook or title, a 2-3 sentence explanation of the angle, the recommended format (short video, long video, blog, LinkedIn, email, or thread), and one sentence on why this idea is relevant or timely this week. Vary the formats – don't give 5 of the same type. End with: 'Reply with a number (1-5) to have me script any of these.'"
```

Lead Follow-Up Reminder — 10:00 AM Tuesday & Thursday

Replace `YOUR_CHANNEL_ID` with your `#operator` channel ID.

▷ TERMINAL COMMAND — COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL

```
openclaw cron add \  
  --name "lead-followup-reminder" \  
  --schedule "0 10 * * 2,4" \  
  --tz "Your/Timezone" \  
  --channel YOUR_CHANNEL_ID \  
  --session-mode isolated \  
  --prompt "Review MEMORY.md for sales pipeline information. Identify any leads or prospects not followed up with in 3 or more days. Post a prioritized follow-up action list with: name and company, date of last contact, conversation context, recommended next action (call/email/DM/proposal), and priority (High/Medium/Low). Sort High priority first. If pipeline is current, post: Pipeline clear – no leads overdue. If no pipeline data exists, ask me to share my current leads so they can be logged."
```

Cron Schedule Syntax Cheat Sheet

A cron expression has 5 parts, separated by spaces:

```

|_____ minute (0-59)
| |_____ hour (0-23)
| | |_____ day of month (1-31)
| | | |_____ month (1-12)
| | | | |_____ day of week (0=Sun, 1=Mon, 2=Tue, 3=Wed, 4=Thu, 5=Fri, 6=Sat)
| | | | |
* * * * *
```

Common Patterns

Expression	When It Runs	Plain English
0 23 * * *	Every day at 11:00 PM	Nightly at 11pm
0 8 * * *	Every day at 8:00 AM	Morning at 8am
0 8 * * 1	Monday only at 8:00 AM	8am every Monday
0 9 * * 1	Monday only at 9:00 AM	9am every Monday
0 10 * * 2,4	Tuesday and Thursday at 10:00 AM	10am Tue + Thu
0 18 * * 0	Sunday at 6:00 PM	Sunday evening 6pm
0 12 * * *	Every day at 12:00 PM	Noon every day
0 18 * * 1-5	Weekdays at 6:00 PM	6pm Mon-Fri
0 9 * * 1-5	Weekdays at 9:00 AM	9am every weekday
0 0 * * 0	Sunday at midnight	Weekly reset at midnight
*/30 * * * *	Every 30 minutes	Every half hour
0 */2 * * *	Every 2 hours	Every 2 hours

Reading a Cron Expression — Quick Method

Read left to right: minute, hour, day, month, weekday.

- * means "every"
- A number means "at this specific value"

- A comma (,) means "and"
- A hyphen (-) means "through" (range)
- */n means "every n units"

Example: 0 10 * * 2,4

→ Minute 0, Hour 10, every day, every month, on day 2 (Tuesday) and day 4 (Thursday)

→ **10:00 AM every Tuesday and Thursday ✓**

Management Commands

View All Your Cron Jobs

▷ **TERMINAL COMMAND — COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL**

```
openclaw cron list
```

Shows every active cron job: name, schedule, channel, and status.

Get Details on a Specific Job

▷ **TERMINAL COMMAND — COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL**

```
openclaw cron get --name "job-name"
```

Shows the full configuration of one job including its prompt text.

Manually Trigger a Job Right Now

▷ **TERMINAL COMMAND — COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL**

```
openclaw cron run --name "job-name"
```

Runs the job immediately, outside its normal schedule. Use this to test a new job before relying on its automated schedule.

Check a Job's Run History

▷ **TERMINAL COMMAND – COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL**

```
openclaw cron runs --name "job-name"
```

Shows the recent execution history for a specific job — when it ran, whether it succeeded or failed.

View Recent Run History for All Jobs

▷ **TERMINAL COMMAND – COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL**

```
openclaw cron runs --limit 20
```

Shows the last 20 runs across all cron jobs. Useful for a quick system health check.

Remove (Delete) a Cron Job

▷ **TERMINAL COMMAND – COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL**

```
openclaw cron remove --name "job-name"
```

Permanently deletes a scheduled job. This cannot be undone — you'd need to recreate it.

Troubleshooting Commands

Check if OpenClaw Gateway is Running

▷ **TERMINAL COMMAND – COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL**

```
openclaw gateway status
```

If cron jobs aren't firing, check this first. The gateway must be running.

Restart the Gateway

▷ **TERMINAL COMMAND – COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL**

```
openclaw gateway restart
```

Use this after any config changes or if jobs seem to have stopped running.

View All Jobs and Their Status at a Glance

▷ **TERMINAL COMMAND – COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL**

```
openclaw cron list
```

Check Last 20 Runs Across All Jobs

▷ **TERMINAL COMMAND – COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL**

```
openclaw cron runs --limit 20
```

Debug a Failing Job

1. Check run history: `openclaw cron runs --name "job-name"`
 2. Look for error messages in the output
 3. Run manually to test: `openclaw cron run --name "job-name"`
 4. Review the prompt for any ambiguity or issues
 5. Check that your channel ID is correct: `openclaw cron get --name "job-name"`
-

Pro Tips

Always Specify Your Timezone

Without `--tz`, jobs run in UTC — which is almost certainly not your local time. Always include:

▷ **TERMINAL COMMAND – COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL**

```
--tz "America/New_York"
```

Common timezone values:

| Location | Timezone Value |

|---|---|

| Eastern (New York) | `America/New_York` |

| Central (Chicago) | `America/Chicago` |

| Mountain (Denver) | `America/Denver` |

| Mountain (Arizona, no DST) | `America/Phoenix` |

| Pacific (Los Angeles) | `America/Los_Angeles` |

| Hawaii | `Pacific/Honolulu` |

| London | `Europe/London` |

| Paris | `Europe/Paris` |

| Sydney | `Australia/Sydney` |

Use `--session-mode isolated` for All Background Jobs

This keeps automated jobs from interfering with your main conversation sessions. It's the right mode for any job that runs on a schedule without you actively watching.

Test Before You Trust

After creating any new cron job, always run it manually once:

▷ **TERMINAL COMMAND – COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL**

```
openclaw cron run --name "your-new-job"
```

Verify it produces the output you expect before you rely on it running at 2am.

Name Your Jobs Clearly

Use lowercase hyphenated names that describe what the job does:

- ☒ `nightly-memory-extraction`
- ☒ `morning-briefing`

-  `weekly-performance-review`
-  `job1`
-  `myjob`

Clear names make `cron list` output readable at a glance.

Review Runs Weekly

Once a week, run:

▷ **TERMINAL COMMAND – COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL**

```
openclaw cron runs --limit 20
```

Scan for any failed runs and investigate. A job silently failing for a week means a week of missed briefings, memory gaps, or lost follow-ups.

Quick Reference Card

Task	Command
Create a job	<code>openclaw cron add --name ... --schedule ... --tz ... --channel ... --session-mode isolated --prompt "..."</code>
List all jobs	<code>openclaw cron list</code>
See job details	<code>openclaw cron get --name "name"</code>
Run a job now	<code>openclaw cron run --name "name"</code>
View run history	<code>openclaw cron runs --name "name"</code>
View all recent runs	<code>openclaw cron runs --limit 20</code>
Remove a job	<code>openclaw cron remove --name "name"</code>
Check gateway	<code>openclaw gateway status</code>
Restart gateway	<code>openclaw gateway restart</code>
